# Sydney Jiya Patel

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## EDUCATION

**Cornell Tech, Cornell University** — **New York, NY**
*Master of Engineering in Computer Science* — *Expected May 2027*
Relevant Coursework: AI for Healthcare, Applied Machine Learning, Product Studio, Designing & Building AI Solutions

**Vanderbilt University** — **Nashville, TN**
*Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Applied Mathematics, Minor in Data Science* — *Graduated May 2026*
GPA: 3.837 / 4.0 | Activities: VandyHacks, Society of Women Engineers, Anchorthon, Special Olympics, Kappa Delta

## SKILLS

**Technical Skills:** Python, Java, JavaScript, Swift, React, Node.js, C/C++, Figma, HTML/CSS, SQL (PostgreSQL), MongoDB, R
**Tools & Platforms:** Git, GitHub, Xcode, Railway, AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, CloudFront, EventBridge), Firebase, Unix/Linux
**Interests (Recreational):** Scuba Diving (PADI & SSI Certified), Travel, New England Patriots (NFL), Ice Skating, Drawing

## PROJECTS

**last night.** – *Software Engineer* | SwiftUI, Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL, AWS, Firebase | http://last-night-app.com/ — *Apr 2026 – Present*

- Designed and built an end-to-end iOS social photo-sharing app with group albums that remain private until a configurable reveal.
- Architected a REST API with Node.js/Express on AWS EC2 and PostgreSQL on RDS to support users, groups, and photo metadata.
- Built a media pipeline using S3 presigned URLs and CloudFront; integrated Firebase Auth, push notifications, and Universal Links.
- Automated time-locked photo releases via AWS Lambda and EventBridge; owned development through testing and App Store launch.

**The Punch** – *iOS Social Media App* — *Aug 2025 – May 2026*

- Developed *The Punch,* a full-stack iOS social application with features including authentication, user profiles, and an interactive feed.
- Engineered the SwiftUI frontend with reusable components and smooth navigation, integrated with a Node.js/Express backend.
- Tested and debugged development and TestFlight builds, contributing to a successful App Store launch.

**SmartSpace** – *Figma Prototype* (Product Design) — *Aug 2025 – Dec 2025*

- Co-led the human-centered redesign of a learning management system to help optimize task flows and reduce cognitive load.
- Designed an interactive prototype, utilizing components, variants, and grid layout to ensure visual consistency and accessibility.
- Conducted formative evaluations to test user flows and navigation paths, then further refined the interface based on user feedback.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**JNR Management Inc.** (Property Management Company, http://jnrhotels.com/) — **Newton, MA**
*Software Engineering & IT Intern* — *May 2025 – Sep 2025*

- Engineered a full-stack single-page application using React and Node.js with RESTful APIs to support property, fund, and renovation management, delivering an accessible, responsive UI and deploying to production via Cloudflare and Railway.
- Built an admin dashboard with CRUD functionality, enabling admins to manage portfolio, news, and team content independently.
- Implemented 1Password with Google SSO and GCP SCIM to automate user provisioning and enforce security protocols via MFA.

## ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Vanderbilt Computer Science Department** — **Nashville, TN**
*Teaching Assistant, Program Design and Data Structures (CS 2201)* — *Jan 2026 – May 2026, Aug 2024 – Dec 2024*

- Facilitated student learning by clarifying complex concepts and teaching efficient problem-solving during weekly office hours.
- Encouraged students to develop independent debugging practices by guiding them through problem-solving processes.
- Graded assignments for over 100 students, delivering constructive feedback to instill safe, clean, and efficient coding practices.

**iD Tech Camps at Massachusetts Institute of Technology** — **Cambridge, MA**
*Lead Instructor* | Python, AI, and Machine Learning courses. — *May 2024 – Aug 2024*

- Led a team of instructors teaching tech courses to 1,000 campers over the summer, fostering a collaborative learning environment.
- Introduced students to neural network fundamentals through Python-based implementation using TensorFlow and Keras.
- Resolved behavioral, technical, and parental challenges by adjusting teaching strategies and maintaining a positive atmosphere.

## LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

**Kappa Delta Sorority** – *Academic Excellence Chair and Philanthropy Committee* — *Jan 2024 – Jan 2025*

- Improved operations by maintaining a Google Drive file system and organizing weekly academic support initiatives for 100+ members.